BLUE CRAYON

a short film

Shooting script · 12 October 2026

Running time 1:30 · Scenes map to the 30 shots in STORYBOARD.md

FADE IN:

1 EXT. MARKET STREET - MORNING

Sun on crowded stalls. Voices. A scooter horn.

PAPA (mid-30s, sleeves rolled, steel watch) bargains at a fruit stall, phone pressed to his ear.

At his feet, THE BOY (5, oversized mustard-yellow hoodie, red sneakers) BOUNCES a red rubber ball.

PAPA
(into phone)
Friday. I said Friday.

The ball CLIPS the Boy's shoe and bounces away.

It ROLLS into a gap between stacked crates, into shadow, and STOPS against a small metal foot.

The foot JERKS back. CLINK.

The Boy CROUCHES. Peers in.

THE ROBOT (child-sized, faded pale-mint paint, rust streaks, a dent in its egg-shaped head) sits curled in the corner, knees to its chest. Two small glowing eyes behind a dark glass visor. It TREMBLES.

They look at each other.

The Robot reaches out one finger. NUDGES the ball. It rolls into the sunlight, into the Boy's hands.

The Boy GRINS. Holds out his open palm.

The Robot's three-fingered hand hovers. Then one fingertip touches the palm. WHIRR.

Its eyes CURVE up into two glowing arcs.

The Boy TUGS Papa's sleeve. Points.

Papa glances into the gap. Sees the Robot.

PAPA
No.

He takes the Boy by the wrist. Walks.

The Boy looks back over his shoulder.

In the shadow between the crates, the Robot lifts one small hand.

CUT TO:

2 INT. APARTMENT - FRONT DOOR - NIGHT

Rain on the glass. The Boy, in pyjamas, eases the door open.

The Robot stands on the doormat. Dripping.

The Boy puts a finger to his lips.

BOY
(whispering)
Shhh.

He pulls it inside.

3 INT. LIVING ROOM - DRAWING CORNER - NIGHT

Lamplight. A low kid's table by the window. Paper. Crayons.

The Robot pinches a blue crayon. It SLIPS. Again. It SLIPS.

The Boy giggles. RIPS a strip of tape. RRRIP. Tapes the crayon to the Robot's finger.

The Robot stares at its finger. Its eyes WIDEN.

It draws one wobbly line.

The Boy claps a hand over his mouth, laughing.

CLICK. The ceiling light SNAPS on.

Papa in the doorway. He sees the Robot.

PAPA
Out.

He points at the front door.

The Boy jumps up. Plants himself in front of the Robot. Spreads his arms wide. His chin TREMBLES.

BOY
No!

Behind his arm, the Robot peeks out.

Papa holds his son's stare. Exhales. Turns. Leaves.

4 MONTAGE - THE CRAYON

MUSIC: a four-note piano theme. Slow. Simple.

– RRRIP. Tape. The crayon goes on the Robot's finger.
– Two heads bent over one sheet of paper.
– A drawing goes up on the wall. Another. The wall fills.
– Dusk. Boy and Robot asleep on a pile of drawings.

5 INT. LIVING ROOM - EVENING

Papa comes in, coat on, bag in hand.

In the corner the Boy shrieks with laughter. The Robot draws a wobbly sun. The wall is covered in drawings.

The Boy holds one up.

BOY
Papa! Look!

Papa looks. The corner of his mouth lifts.

Then it's gone. He turns away.

6 INT. KITCHEN - EVENING

Papa at the counter.

The Robot shuffles up. Holds up its own drawing: a crooked stick-man with a big smile. Papa.

Papa walks past. Doesn't look.

The Robot lowers the paper. Slowly.

7 INT. BOY'S BEDROOM - DAY

Grey light. The Boy in bed. Flushed cheeks. Damp hair.

Papa sits on the edge of the bed. Presses a wet cloth to the Boy's forehead.

A soft knock. The Robot in the doorway, a glass of water held in both hands.

Papa takes the glass without looking at it. Closes the door on the Robot. Gently.

LATER

The Robot is back, holding the Boy's blanket.

PAPA
(not looking up)
Not now.

The door CLOSES.

The Robot faces the door. Its eyes DIM.

8 INT. LIVING ROOM - DRAWING CORNER - DAY

Rain on the window. Silence.

The Robot sits at the little table. An unfinished drawing lies there, turned away from us. Crayons scattered. The tape roll on its side. Under the table, the red ball.

The Robot stares at the drawing. Doesn't move.

9 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Dark. RED and BLUE light pulses across the walls. Across the Robot's face.

A SIREN fades into the distance.

The front door CLICKS shut.

10 INT. APARTMENT - FRONT DOOR - DAY

Rain. The door opens.

Papa steps in. Alone. Black suit. Soaked.

He walks past the Robot. Doesn't look.

11 MONTAGE - EMPTY

A CLOCK ticks.

– Sunlight crawls across the living room. Day. Night. Day. The Robot never moves. Dust settles on its head.
– A drawing peels off the wall. Drifts to the floor.
– The red ball, flat, under the table.
– The kitchen at night. Papa at the table in an undershirt. Stubble. Empty bottles. The open fridge is the only light.

12 INT. LIVING ROOM - DRAWING CORNER - NIGHT

The Robot's eyes FLICKER. Brighten.

Its head LIFTS. Servos CREAK.

It picks up the unfinished drawing. The blue crayon is still taped to its finger.

13 INT. HALLWAY - NIGHT

Dark. The Robot walks. Its eye-glow is the only light.

It stops at the Boy's door. Pushes it open.

14 INT. BOY'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Papa sits on the floor against the empty little bed. A bottle in his hand.

The Robot crosses to him. Holds out the drawing, the way it did in the kitchen.

Papa doesn't look.

The eye-glow falls on the paper.

He looks.

INSERT - THE DRAWING

Crayon on paper. A tall stick-man: PAPA, the first P backwards. A small boy in a yellow top: ME. A little round robot with huge eyes, a red heart above it. All three holding hands under a big yellow sun, half coloured in.

BACK TO SCENE

BOY (V.O.)
(far away)
Papa. Look.

Papa's jaw CLAMPS. His breath catches. Holds.

It breaks.

He pulls the Robot into his chest. SOBS.

OVER PAPA'S SHOULDER

The Robot. Chin on his shoulder. Arms hanging at its sides. The drawing dangles from its taped hand.

Its two big eyes stay wide. Still. Fixed on the empty bed.

MUSIC: the four-note theme. Three notes. The fourth never comes.

CUT TO BLACK.

BLUE CRAYON

THE END